AN ECLECTIC TECHNOLOGIES FOUNDATIONAL DEFINITION

FD-LS — Local Sovereignty

Foundational Definition: Protective Function Independent of Reachable Digital Authority

Version 0.6 — DRAFT · 2 October 2026

Tim Roxey

Eclectic Technologies

tim.roxey@gmail.com · 410.474.9240 (mobile/Signal)

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Parent: None. This instrument defines. See §2.
Companion root definitions: FD-BL (the Bright Line); FD-LD (layer decomposition and determinism); FD-EV (the envelope); FD-BR (the Broker)
Originated by: Project 5 — Grid Operations and Energy Policy, which developed the construct for protective relay independence and holds it as conceptual ownership. See §2.3.

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1. Purpose and the Defect This Instrument Corrects

Local Sovereignty is one of the core constructs the whole portfolio inherits. It is named in Project 0's core-constructs list, it is one of the three signature constructs of the DBA-MA series, and Project 3 has built a governing principle of its own, the Analyst Sovereignty Principle, on its reasoning (§6).

Until this instrument issued, it was the only one of the core constructs with no Foundational Definition. The Bright Line has FD-BL, and the Broker role-type and its Command Broker instantiation have FD-BR (FD-BR §4.2). Local Sovereignty's definition of record was §3.1 of Project5_Introduction_For_Sibling_Projects — an instrument whose own document control states that a card *is an orientation instrument*, *not a standards instrument* and *does not establish normative requirements*.

So the corpus inherited a core construct whose only definition sat in a document that disclaims normative force, and every downstream use of it was a restatement rather than a citation, because there was nothing to cite. That is the defect. This instrument closes it, and it closes it in the direction the corpus already knows is correct: the definition is held once, in the family that exists to hold definitions once, and is propagated by reference.

2. Authority, Family, Origination, and What Is Not Altered

2.1 Precedence

This instrument owns the definition of local sovereignty for all documents in the corpus.

Foundational Definitions take precedence over sector frameworks, facility class documents, application guides, vendor companions, annexes and implementation guidance. A sector framework applies the construct *within* its sector; it does not define it. This is the tier rule stated at FD-BL §2.1 and it applies here without exception. Propagation is by reference to this instrument, not by restating its text.

2.2 The Foundational Definitions family

A concept belongs in this family when the correctness of other documents depends on agreeing what kind of thing it is (FD-BL §2.2). Local sovereignty meets that test in a specific and demonstrated way: Project 3's Analyst Sovereignty Principle is stated as an application of it to the human operator, and whether that extension is sound depends entirely on what the parent construct asserts. An extension of a construct that has no definition of record cannot be checked, only believed.

FD-LS is a companion root to FD-BL, FD-LD, FD-EV and FD-BR. FD-BL owns placement; FD-LD owns layer decomposition and determinism; FD-EV owns the envelope; FD-LS owns local sovereignty. None owns the others' vocabulary, and §4 states the boundary between this instrument and FD-BL, which is the one most likely to be crossed.

2.3 Origination and credit

The construct is Project 5's, by the author's determination of 6 September 2026, and this instrument does not transfer it. What moves here is the definition's *home*, not its authorship: a Foundational Definition sits in Project 0 because that is where the corpus holds what every project inherits, and Project 0 owns no sector and analyzes no facility.

Project 5 developed local sovereignty for protective relay independence and states it at §3.1 of its introduction card under *my conceptual ownership*. The substantive content of §3 below is that section elevated to definitional form. Two of its formulations are carried into the corpus verbatim because they are the construct rather than a description of it — *the burden of proof is on the intermediation, not on the independence*, and the characterization of the analog backstop as *a strategic technological retreat to a defense line that cannot be compromised through the cyber attack surface*. Both are Project 5's words.

Project 5 may reject this instrument or issue its own successor, and this instrument will be withdrawn or re-parented on that project's say-so. The drafting by Project 0 is a service, not a claim.

Origination and lineage are two claims about two different things, and this instrument separates them rather than choosing between them. The construct's origination is Project 5's, as stated above and unmoved by this paragraph. **The lineage of the property the construct names — the engineering artifact in which it was first instantiated, and the documented chain from that artifact forward — is Project 7's.** Neither claim is evidence for or against the other: a device can embody a property years before anyone names it, and naming it is not a claim to have built it first.

2.4 What this instrument does not alter

This instrument is definitional. It states no new operational requirement, alters no requirement of FD-BL, FD-BL-D1, FD-BL-D2, FD-EV or FD-BR, and changes no placement determination. It does not decide Bright Line placement for any action (§4). It does not amend Project 3's Analyst Sovereignty Principle, which is that project's instrument to state; §6 records the extension and reserves its scope.

3. The Definition

3.1 What kind of thing local sovereignty is

Local sovereignty is a property of a protective function: that the function executes on physical law, colocated with the asset it protects, and requires no authority from any reachable system to act.

It is a property of a function, not of a device, a layer, an architecture or a vendor. A given piece of equipment may host functions that have the property and functions that do not. The property is assessed per protective function, in the same way that placement under FD-BL is assessed per action.

3.2 The three conditions

A protective function is **locally sovereign** when all three hold.

Physical law. The function's decision is a measurement against a setpoint, and the relationship between the measurement and the action is physics rather than inference. The test is that the decision is a fixed function of measured quantities and setpoints. It is deterministic within a stated input bound and formally testable as deployed, in the sense of FD-LD §4.3, and it contains no learned or stochastic element. The measured quantities are sensed at the function, or reach it over a path that nothing on the reachable side can reach. A distance relay tripping on impedance measurement is executing physics, whether the impedance is computed by an electromechanical element or by a numerical algorithm over sampled voltage and current. An under-frequency load-shedding scheme shedding load when frequency drops below a threshold is executing physics. A machine-learned classifier is not, however deterministic its inference, because it contains a learned element.

Colocation. The function is sited with the asset it protects. It does not depend on a decision taken elsewhere and delivered to it.

No reachable authority. This is the condition that carries the weight, and *reachable* is the operative word. It has two limbs.

At the time of acting, the limb is absolute. Nothing on the reachable side can withhold, delay or induce the function's action, whether by command or by corrupting what the function measures. The function needs no communication channel, no firmware update, no network connection and no permission from any system an adversary could reach in order to act.

Ahead of acting, the limb is conditional. Nothing on the reachable side can alter what the function acts on — its setpoints, its logic or its bypass state — except through a governed act.

A **governed act** is a deliberate, authenticated act by a qualified human, recorded, which no automated element on the reachable side can perform or complete alone. Where an in-scope component proposes the change, the change is also an action under FD-BL and is placed on its own consequence (FD-BL §4.4).

Failure of any one condition, or of either limb, defeats the property. A function that measures physics but waits for a permissive from a networked controller fails the first limb, however local its hardware. A colocated function whose setpoints are alterable from a reachable system without a governed act fails the second. A function whose measurements arrive over a reachable network fails the physical-law condition and the first limb, because false measurements can induce or suppress its action while its setpoints, logic and bypass state are untouched.

Every locally sovereign function is a carved-out component. The physical-law condition is the FD-LD carve-out test with learned and stochastic elements excluded, so a locally sovereign function is deterministic within a stated input bound and formally testable, and it is outside Bright Line analysis by the carve-out (FD-LD §4.3). The converse does not hold. A deterministic machine-learned model, a deterministic function awaiting a networked permissive, or one acting on measurements delivered over a reachable network, can meet the carve-out and still fail this section. Actions taken upon a locally sovereign function by an in-scope component remain within Bright Line analysis (FD-BL §4.4).

3.3 The burden of proof

The burden of proof is on the intermediation, not on the independence.

This is the operative clause of the construct and it is Project 5's sentence. Its force is procedural: independence is not a legacy artifact requiring justification against modernization. **Any proposal that introduces digital intermediation into a protective decision path shall carry the argument for that intermediation**, and it is the proposal that must be evaluated. The default is not neutral between the two.

It follows that "this function has always been independent" is not a defect to be remedied, and that the party proposing to intermediate carries the argument. An instrument that reverses this — that treats independence as the exception needing a case — has departed from the construct whatever else it says.

3.4 The consequence-asymmetry ground

Local sovereignty is grounded in consequence asymmetry rather than in conservatism about technology. A protective relay costs thousands of dollars and can be replaced in hours; a large power transformer costs millions, requires years of lead time, and weighs hundreds of tons, and its loss extends to everyone who loses power during the replacement. **The relay that trips correctly and saves the transformer is not an expense; it is the cheapest available insurance against the most expensive available failure.**

The ground matters because it makes the construct arguable rather than doctrinal. Where the asymmetry does not hold, the argument for local sovereignty is weaker, and this instrument does not

assert the property as a universal good independent of what it protects. Consequence asymmetry as a general analytical structure is Project 5's, at §3.2 of its card, and is cited here rather than defined.

3.5 The analog backstop

Where digital control is proliferating and inverter-based resources are displacing synchronous generation, the deliberate preservation of analog protective functions is not a refusal to modernize. It is, in Project 5's words, *a strategic technological retreat to a defense line that cannot be compromised through the cyber attack surface* — a design philosophy rather than a fallback position.

Recorded here because it is the form the construct most often takes in argument, and because a reader who meets it without the framing at §3.3 and §3.4 will mistake it for nostalgia.

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4. The Boundary With FD-BL — Local Sovereignty Does Not Decide Placement

A locally sovereign function is not thereby below the Bright Line, and a function that lacks the property is not thereby above it.

This section exists because the corpus has already paid for the fused version of it. The assumed-placement screen of 3 September 2026 (FD-BL Reconciliation/R3_Assumed_Placement_Screen) found a formulation — *below the line by their nature*, *above the line by definition*, and their variants — propagated into fifteen live masters across two projects, in which a property of a system was allowed to settle a placement question that FD-BL reserves to the consequence of each individual action. Local sovereignty is exactly the kind of property that invites that fusion, because a function meeting all three conditions at §3.2 is plainly not an AI-originated command and it is tempting to conclude that placement follows.

It does not follow, and the two constructs answer different questions.

FD-BL asks: what is the consequence of this individual action, and does it therefore require authorization by a Command Broker? Placement is action by action, on consequence, per FD-BL §4.2–§4.3.

FD-LS asks: does this protective function execute independently of reachable digital authority? The answer is a property of the function, and it is either true or false of the function as built.

The two interact in one direction only. **Local sovereignty describes the protective functions that remain when the governed architecture — in-scope components and the Bright Line enforcement around them — fails, is compromised, or is unavailable.** In FD-LD's vocabulary those functions sit on the infrastructure side of the boundary (§3.2). Local sovereignty is what the design is falling back to, not a criterion for deciding what an in-scope component may do. **An instrument shall not cite FD-LS to establish that an action needs no Broker.** The correct citation, if the conclusion is right, is to FD-BL on the consequence of that action.

The conforming form of the sentence is stated at FD-LD §4.3 and is cited rather than composed again: a component that meets the carve-out is outside the Command Broker obligation for the actions it produces while its inputs lie within the stated input bound, **and is not thereby below the line**; placement stays consequence, per action.

5. Worked Examples

Illustrative; sector variants may be substituted without altering the definition.

A distance relay tripping on impedance measurement. Physics, colocated, no reachable authority required. Locally sovereign on all three conditions. Whether any AI-assisted function that *recommends* a setting change to that relay sits above the Bright Line is a separate question decided under FD-BL on the consequence of the change, and the relay's local sovereignty does not answer it.

An under-frequency load-shedding scheme. Sheds load when frequency drops below a threshold — physics, colocated, no permission required. Locally sovereign. A predictive scheme that shed load on a forecast delivered over a network would not be, because the third condition fails: the action depends on something reachable.

A colocated protective function awaiting a permissive from a networked controller. Physics and colocation hold; the third condition fails. Not locally sovereign, and the location of the hardware does not rescue it. This is the case the word *reachable* is in the definition to catch.

A protective function whose setpoints can be altered from a reachable engineering workstation without a governed act. The function executes on physics when it acts, but what it treats as the threshold is alterable from the reachable side. Not locally sovereign. Whether the alteration itself is an above-line action is an FD-BL question about that action.

The same function, where a setpoint change from the engineering workstation requires a governed act. The change can be made only by a deliberate, authenticated act of a qualified human, recorded, which no automated element on the reachable side can perform or complete alone. The conditional limb holds, and if the function's action at the time of acting needs nothing from the reachable side, the function is locally sovereign. If an in-scope component proposed the change, the proposal is an action placed under FD-BL on its consequence.

A relay on an IEC 61850 process bus. The relay's voltages and currents arrive as sampled values from merging units over an Ethernet network. If that network is reachable, false samples can trip the function or hold it from tripping while its setpoints, logic and bypass state remain untouched, so the function fails the physical-law condition and the absolute limb, and is not locally sovereign. If nothing on the reachable side can reach the process bus, the measurement path does not defeat the property, and the function is assessed on the other conditions. A misoperation commanded through a reachable path is the shape the Aurora work demonstrated, and the definition does not certify it as sovereign.

One relay, several protective elements. A line relay may host pilot-assisted protection — line current differential, permissive overreaching transfer trip, directional comparison blocking — which depends on a channel from the remote terminal, and also Zone 1 and timed step-distance elements, which act on what the relay measures at its own terminals. The pilot elements fail colocation and the absolute limb; the Zone 1 and step-distance elements can pass. The property attaches to the protective element, not to the relay (§3.1), and any count of the installed base is made element by element.

6. Extension Beyond the Protective Layer, and Its Reservation

Project 3 states the **Analyst Sovereignty Principle** as this construct applied to the human operator: the analyst is the decision-maker, AI-assisted tools do not decide or act autonomously, no upstream system including the assistant overrides the analyst's authority over consequential action, and — carrying §3.3 across — the burden of proof sits on intermediation rather than on independence.

What transfers is §3.3, the burden-of-proof clause, which is about who must argue and is indifferent to whether the independent element is a relay or a person. **What does not transfer is §3.2**: a human analyst does not execute on physical law, is not colocated with an asset in the sense the second condition means, and the third condition takes a different shape when the thing that must not be overridden is a judgement rather than a trip.

6.1 Determined jointly 7 September 2026 — the Analyst Sovereignty Principle is an analogy, not an inheritance

There is no general form. Local sovereignty is the protective-function property defined at §3, and it has no parent of which the protective and human cases are both instances.

Closed jointly by Projects 5 and 3 on 7 September 2026, the closure dating to Project 3's acceptance. How that dating was corrected, and why the defect it corrected was invisible, is kept in the Record.

What the Analyst Sovereignty Principle inherits is one clause and not the construct. It carries §3.3 — *the burden of proof is on the intermediation, not on the independence* — because that clause is about the structure of an argument and is indifferent to what the independent element is. It does not carry the three conditions, and it is therefore **not an instance of local sovereignty.** It is a distinct principle that reasons the same way about a different subject.

The reasoning is that the three conditions are the construct. §3.2 states that all three must hold and that failure of any one defeats the property. A principle that satisfies none of them cannot be an instance of a property those conditions define, however similar its argumentative shape. **The shared shape is the analogy; the conditions are the construct.** Treating the human case as an inheritance would make local sovereignty a family whose defining test its own members fail, which is the shape §4 exists to prevent in a different register.

What this changes. The term *local sovereignty* stays reserved for the protective-function property. **Project 3's Analyst Sovereignty Principle is that project's own construct**, sound on its own ground, inheriting a clause by citation rather than a property by extension — and the citation is to §3.3 of this instrument, which makes it a live cross-reference rather than a restatement. **Project 3's card and instructions should say analogy where they said the concept was inherited**, and that is Project 3's text to change.

What it does not change. Nothing about the principle's soundness. Nothing about Project 3's ownership of it. And nothing about Project 5's origination of local sovereignty, which is where Project 3 first met the reasoning and says so.

This instrument reserves the term *local sovereignty* for the protective-function property defined at §3, and records the Analyst Sovereignty Principle as **a distinct principle owned by Project 3 that inherits §3.3 by citation.**

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7. Conformance

This instrument governs the construct. Restatements are conformed at each instrument's next revision, and the tier rule at §2.1 applies whether or not an instrument is named here.

Local sovereignty is cited by designation without a version token, per the citation-form determination; **FD-REG is authoritative for this instrument's version state.**

Three classes of existing site are anticipated and none is swept blind. Instruments that **describe** the construct in their own words — chiefly Project 5's card §3.1, the DBA-MA material that carries it as a signature construct, and Project 3's card and instructions — conform by replacing the restatement with a citation at their next revision, and Project 5's card is the exception that may keep its statement as the originating account. Instruments that **apply** the construct conform by citation only; no application changes. And any instrument that uses local sovereignty, or a property like it, **to settle a placement question** is a §4 defect and is conformed on the pattern of the assumed-placement screen, by reading for the conclusion language rather than for the construct's name, per CR-VA.

The sites are not yet enumerated. No count is stated here, because a count taken from memory is the defect CR-VA exists to catch and a screen is not a count.

8. Author Decisions — Two Closed 7 September 2026, One Closed 27 September 2026, and the Restated §3.2 Accepted 2 October 2026

~~**Whether Project 5 accepts this instrument as drafted**, amends it, or issues its own.~~ **CLOSED. Accepted as drafted by Project 5, 7 September 2026**, at Return_Note_2026-09-07_from_P5. Two elements Project 0 had flagged as drafting rather than construct were put to that project and **both are kept**: the three conditions at §3.2, with *reachable* as the operative word; and §3.4's record that the consequence-asymmetry ground makes the construct **arguable rather than doctrinal**. Project 5's stated reason for keeping the second is that an unqualified claim is defeated once and permanently, while a qualified one survives the scrutiny the instrument exists to withstand.

The restated §3.2 is accepted by Project 5, 2 October 2026, at Return_Note_2026-10-02_from_P5_to_Project_0_Section_3_2_Is_Accepted_as_Resolved. Project 5 accepted the split of the third condition in principle on its first return note of that day and asked two amendments, both taken (see the revision entry for v0.6); it then accepted §3.2 as resolved, with the process-bus and element-granularity examples at §5. The acceptance is of this master as read by Project 5 on 2 October 2026. **It does not carry to any later change that touches §3.2 or those two examples.**

~~**Whether the general form at §6 is opened.**~~ **CLOSED. There is no general form** — stated at §6.1. The Analyst Sovereignty Principle is an analogy inheriting §3.3 by citation, not an instance of the construct. **Closed jointly by Projects 5 and 3, dating to Project 3's acceptance of 7 September 2026** — corrected at v0.3, the v0.2 issue having recorded it as closed by one owner of a question reserved to two.

~~**Whether a production render is cut** into the production/ edition set.~~ **CLOSED. A render is cut, on the author's decision of 27 September 2026**, and this instrument is a member of *FD — Foundational Definitions, September 2026 Edition*. The August 2026 edition was cut before this instrument issued, so FD-LS makes its first published appearance in the September edition. Its origination credit at §2.3 is carried on the edition's contents page as it stands here.

One consequence of the §3.2 acceptance is recorded rather than resolved. The three conditions are narrower than the originating card's single-sentence form: a colocated function awaiting a permissive from a networked controller fails the third, and so does one whose setpoints are alterable from a reachable workstation without a governed act. **Which bulk electric system (BES) functions currently described as locally sovereign would fail that test has not been established**, and it is Project 5's to find. It is not a defect in the definition; it is the definition doing work.

9. Foundational References

FD-BL — the Bright Line (placement, granularity, scope, obligation), and §4 above, which states the boundary. FD-LD — layer decomposition and determinism. FD-EV — the envelope. FD-BR — the Broker role-type. FD-REG — authoritative for the version state of this family. Project5_Introduction_For_Sibling_Projects §3.1 and §3.2 — the originating account and the consequence-asymmetry framework. Project3_Introduction_For_Sibling_Projects — the Analyst Sovereignty Principle. FD-BL Reconciliation/R3_Assumed_Placement_Screen — the fused-placement defect §4 exists to prevent. CR-VA — verification against applications.

Provenance. aurora_brightline_v03b — the Aurora through-line, Project 7 — for the lineage of the property at §2.3. How that evidence is held is recorded in the Record.

Record

This Record carries provenance moved out of §§1–9 at v0.6. It is not part of the definition, and nothing in it varies §§1–9.

R.1 How the gap was found

Until v0.6 this stood at the end of §1.

It was found by asking who owns the construct, not by a sweep. Project 3 raised the question against its own card on 6 September 2026; the author determined that Local Sovereignty is Project 5's; and the absence of any instrument to carry that ownership was the immediate consequence.

R.2 Why Project 0 drafted the instrument

Until v0.6, §2.3 gave the reason for Project 0's drafting in full:

Project 5 may reject this instrument or issue its own successor, and this instrument will be withdrawn or re-parented on that project's say-so. Project 0 drafted it because the author asked for it and because Project 5 has no _admin set, no instructions and no register in which to place it; the drafting is a service, not a claim.

R.3 The separation of origination from lineage

Until v0.6 this stood in §2.3, after the paragraph that separates the two claims, which stays there.

The separation was made by Project 7 on 8 September 2026, and it cost that project the stronger form of its own claim. Its card had read *both inherit from this through-line* — a claim of **descent** rather than of precedence — and that sentence is withdrawn, because **the artifact chain is documented at every link and the link between the artifact and the construct is documented nowhere.** Nothing shows that

the articulation drew on the earlier engineering work, and nothing shows that it did not. **That is the transmission question Project 7 exists to ask of others**, applied to itself at the one point where the answer would have borne on a Foundational Definition's credit. **A disposition that costs its author the strongest version of its own claim is the reason to trust it rather than a reason to soften it.**

R.4 How the joint closure at §6.1 was dated

Until v0.6 the following stood in §6.1, between the determination and the statement of what the Analyst Sovereignty Principle inherits. "This section" in it means §6.1, and "this project" means Project 0.

Closed jointly by Projects 5 and 3, and the closure dates to Project 3's acceptance. Project 5 stated the determination at Return_Note_2026-09-07_from_P5_FD-LS_Accepted_and_the_General_Form_Determined §4. **Project 3 accepted it at Return_Note_2026-09-07_from_P3_The_Analogy_Determination_Is_Accepted_and_Executed_and_the_General_Form_Was_Joint, and that acceptance is what closed the question.**

The dating is not a formality and it is corrected at this project's request rather than found later. §6 reserved this question to **Projects 3 and 5 jointly**, and Note_2026-09-07d_from_P0 §4 put it in terms that leave no room: *whether the protective and the human cases are instances of one construct is unopened, and **neither of you can settle it alone.*** The v0.2 issue of this section recorded the determination as made by one owner with the second notified. **That was wrong about who decided, and the answer being correct does not cure it: a determination that happens to be right is not thereby jointly made.**

Project 3 put it back; Project 5 declined the reading that would have excused it. That project was offered the construction that §6's reservation ran to the *term* rather than to the *question*, under which the closure would have been its to make. It refused, on the ground that the reading was available only because it had been offered and was the one construction under which that project had not erred — *a project that records its errors on Monday and takes the exculpatory reading on Tuesday has not been recording errors; it has been recording the ones that cost it nothing*.

Why the defect was invisible, which is the part worth keeping. An agreed outcome leaves no artifact distinguishing it from an unopposed one. The defects this corpus is practiced at catching leave something **present and wrong** — a stale token, a fused placement claim, a false sentence above a cut line — findable by a reading or a hash. **Here the artifact is absent and the outcome is correct**, and there is nothing on any surface to find. It was catchable only by the other owner noticing it had not been asked, which is what happened.

The general shape, recorded here because both owners declined to press it as a candidate. Where an instrument reserves a question to two owners, **the second owner's acceptance is a constitutive act and not a formality**: the question is not closed when the first owner answers it, however correct the answer. That is a different failure from the ones CR-AR and CR-VA name — nothing is unrecorded and nothing is unverified, and the record is still wrong about who decided.

R.5 The provenance citation and how its evidence is held

Until v0.6 the following stood in §9 after the provenance citation, which stays there. One sentence is not carried: see R.6.

Provenance. aurora_brightline_v03b — the Aurora through-line, Project 7 — for the lineage of the property at §2.3. **This instrument cited no provenance source from first issue through v0.3.** Project 0

identified the omission on 6 September 2026 and recorded it as its own; it then stood through two further versions. **An omission named and left standing across two bumps is a defect the naming did not fix**, and it is recorded here rather than quietly closed.

Two things travel with that citation and are recorded because a later reader should meet them where the citation is, not somewhere else. The cited artifacts are **not held in Project 7's tree**, and the through-line's own Document Notes state that the December 2015 circuit diagram is archived with that project, which its folder does not bear out — **the evidence is cited and not held**, which is a weaker position than the citation reads as.

R.6 The disclosure remark, closed

From v0.4 to v0.5 this instrument recorded, in §9 and in the 0.4 revision entry, that the Aurora through-line summarizes a March 2017 prototype report marked TLP:RED, and called that an open disclosure question with the author. On 2 October 2026 the author confirmed that the report is no longer TLP:RED. The question is closed, and at the author's direction the remark is removed from §9 and from the 0.4 entry. Removing text from a revision entry is a deliberate exception to the family's practice of annotating such entries rather than editing them, made because the remark was a disclosure question that should not be repeated once closed. The September 2026 Edition stays as published.

Revision History

0.6 — 2 October 2026. Issued in the October 2026 Edition, and recorded in FD-REG v0.22 in the same act. One cumulative entry for the step of the Action Plan for the October 2026 Edition that opens this instrument (Step 6).

Step 6, 2 October 2026 (F-07; F-19, F-21, F-22, F-24, F-25, F-27; Finding S2-3). **F-07, on the author's determination of 2 October 2026 (Decision E, Option E3):** §3.2's third condition is stated once, in two limbs. At the time of acting nothing on the reachable side can withhold or delay the action, and this limb is absolute. Ahead of acting nothing on the reachable side can alter the function's setpoints, logic or bypass state except through a governed act, and this limb is conditional. A governed act is defined: a deliberate, authenticated act by a qualified human, recorded, which no automated element on the reachable side can perform or complete alone; where an in-scope component proposes the change, the change is also placed under FD-BL. The physical-law condition takes the FD-LD test, with no learned or stochastic element, and a numerical relay computing impedance is stated to meet it. §3.2 states that every locally sovereign function is a carved-out component and that the converse does not hold. §5 adds an example in which the conditional limb holds. The question §8 leaves open, which BES functions now described as locally sovereign would fail the test, stays open. **F-21:** §4 is reworded in FD-LD's vocabulary, dropping "protective layer" and "governed layer"; FD-LD §3 points to §3.2 for the relation; §1 names FD-BR as the source of the Command Broker instantiation and gives no count of the core constructs; the header adds FD-BR as a companion root. **F-27:** §3.3 and §4 each carry one "shall." **Finding S2-3 and F-25:** §4's conforming sentence cites FD-LD §4.3, drops "may operate autonomously" and replaces "in-bound" with the stated input bound; BES is expanded at §8. **F-19:** the assumed-placement screen is named by title at §4 and §7, and the bare "R3" token is dropped. **F-24:** provenance narrative moves to a new Record section: how the gap was found (R.1), Project 0's reason for drafting (R.2), Project 7's separation of origination from lineage (R.3), the dating of the joint closure at §6.1 (R.4), and how the provenance evidence is held (R.5). The TLP:RED remark is removed from §9 and, at the author's direction, from the 0.4 entry below; R.6 records its closure once, with its date. §§3.1, 3.3 to 3.5, §6's determination and §8's

decisions are otherwise unchanged. **Amended the same day on Project 5's return note** (Return_Note_2026-10-02_from_P5_to_Project_0_The_Split_Is_Right_but_Section_3_2_Is_Not_Yet_Accepted_Two_Amendments_Are_Asked), which accepted the split and found that no limb reached a trip induced or suppressed by corrupting the measurement. On the author's decision of 2 October 2026 both of Project 5's remedies are taken, as one test: the physical-law condition requires the measured quantities to be sensed at the function or to reach it over a path nothing on the reachable side can reach, and the absolute limb forbids the reachable side to withhold, delay or induce the action, by command or by corrupting what the function measures. §5 gains the IEC 61850 process-bus example, and, on Project 5's offer and the author's decision, an example stating that the property attaches to the protective element and not to the relay. **Project 5 accepted §3.2 as resolved the same day**, and §8 records the acceptance.

Review of 2 October 2026. On the author's instruction to apply the cold review of the October 2026 Edition review draft as recommended (FD-BL Reconciliation/Independent_Review_2026-10-02_FD_October_2026_Edition_Review_Draft_v0_1), this instrument takes findings G-14, G-16; each edit is quoted in the review's application record.

0.5 — 27 September 2026. Closes §8's render decision on the author's instruction: a production render is cut, and FD-LS enters *FD — Foundational Definitions*, *September 2026 Edition*, its first published appearance. No change to the definition or to §2.3's origination credit. Project 5 is told.

0.4 — 8 September 2026. Carries the two changes Project 7 asked for on its origin determination, neither of which moves the credit at §2.3. That project separated three questions doing the work of one word — who built the artifact that first embodied the property, who first articulated it as a named construct, and who holds the definition of record — and **separated, the two accounts do not conflict.** §2.3 now states that origination is Project 5's and the lineage of the property is Project 7's, and that neither is evidence for or against the other. **Project 7's *both inherit from this through-line* is recorded as withdrawn**, being a claim of descent rather than precedence: the artifact chain is documented at every link and **the link between artifact and construct is documented nowhere**, which is that project's own transmission test applied to itself where it had never been applied.

§9 gains the provenance citation it has lacked since first issue — aurora_brightline_v03b — and records that Project 0 named the omission on 6 September, called it its own, and let it stand through v0.2 and v0.3. **An omission named and left standing across two bumps is a defect the naming did not fix.** One condition travels with the citation and sits beside it rather than elsewhere: the cited artifacts are **not held** in Project 7's tree, against a Document Note claiming one of them is archived there.

Nothing in §§1, 3–8 is altered, the credit does not move, and Project 5's acceptance of 7 September stands undisturbed. FD-REG is carried in the same act.

0.3 — 7 September 2026. Corrects §6.1's account of who closed the general-form question, at the request of both owners. Nothing in §§1–5, §7 or the determination itself is altered: there is no general form, and both projects hold that.

What was wrong. v0.2 recorded the closure as made by Project 5 and dated it to that project's return note, with Project 3 notified. **§6 reserved the question to Projects 3 and 5 jointly**, and Note_2026-09-07d_from_P0 §4 stated that *neither of you can settle it alone.* **The record was wrong about who decided.** Project 3 put it back at its return note of 7 September and Project 5 endorsed the correction against its own earlier request, declining the available reading that would have made the closure its to make.

The closure now dates to Project 3's acceptance, and §6.1 states that acceptance as the constitutive act. The reason is the one this instrument was drafted on: **a right of rejection that lives only in a note is a right a later reader will not find**, and the same argument applies to a joint closure — an instrument showing a jointly-reserved question closed by one owner, with the second owner's agreement sitting only in correspondence, is the shape §2.3 exists to prevent.

§6.1 also records why the defect was invisible, which both owners identified independently: an agreed outcome leaves no artifact distinguishing it from an unopposed one, so nothing is present and wrong and nothing on any surface can be read or hashed to find it. **It was catchable only by the other owner noticing it had not been asked.**

The general shape is recorded at §6.1 and is not registered as a candidate, both owners having declined to propose a designation on a single instance: *where an instrument reserves a question to two owners, the second owner's acceptance is a constitutive act and not a formality.*

FD-REG carried to v0.11 in the same act.

0.2 — 7 September 2026. Accepted by Project 5 as drafted, and the general form determined not to exist. Two of the three §8 decisions close.

Project 5 issued its acceptance at Return_Note_2026-09-07_from_P5_FD-LS_Accepted_and_the_General_Form_Determined — **that project's first issued correspondence in the corpus.** Both elements Project 0 had flagged as drafting rather than construct are kept: the three conditions at §3.2 and §3.4's *arguable rather than doctrinal* record. Nothing in §§1–5 or §7 is altered by this revision.

§6 gains §6.1 and the reservation is discharged. *There is no general form.* The Analyst Sovereignty Principle inherits §3.3 by citation and does not carry §3.2, so it is **not an instance of local sovereignty** but a distinct principle owned by Project 3 that reasons the same way about a different subject. The ground is that **the three conditions are the construct**: a principle satisfying none of them cannot be an instance of a property those conditions define, and treating it as one would make local sovereignty a family whose defining test its own members fail.

Notice is owed to Project 3 and is issued in the same act. That project's card §157 records the ancestry question as open at its §9, and its instructions carry the Analyst Sovereignty Principle as inheriting the concept Project 5 established. **Both should say analogy**, and both are Project 3's text to change; the determination does not edit them.

One consequence is recorded and not resolved at §8: the three conditions are narrower than the originating card's single-sentence form, and which BES functions currently described as locally sovereign would fail the third condition has not been established. That is Project 5's to find and is not a defect in the definition.

FD-REG is carried to v0.10 in the same act, the discipline that makes the bare citation form safe.

0.1 — 6 September 2026. Initial issue, closing the gap found when the author determined that Local Sovereignty is Project 5's and no instrument existed to carry the definition: the construct was inherited corpus-wide while its only definition of record sat in an introduction card whose own document control disclaims normative force. Elevates Project 5's card §3.1 to definitional form, crediting that project as originator and carrying two of its formulations verbatim. States the property as three conditions assessed per protective function, with *reachable* as the operative word in the third; states the burden-

of-proof clause as the construct's operative sentence; grounds the construct in consequence asymmetry rather than in conservatism, and records that the argument is weaker where the asymmetry does not hold. **§4 states the boundary with FD-BL** — local sovereignty does not decide placement — on the R3 assumed-placement precedent, and reuses the conforming sentence rather than composing a second one. Records Project 3's Analyst Sovereignty Principle as a named extension, sound on the burden-of-proof clause and reserved as to the general form. Enumerates no conformance sites, because a count taken from memory is the defect CR-VA exists to catch.